

Unit Y320: From Colonialism to Independence: The British Empire 1857–1965

This theme focuses on the changing nature of the British Empire over this period. Learners should understand the factors which encouraged and discouraged change during this period. Learners should study developments across the whole of the Empire, including Asia (e.g. India, Malaya), North Africa and the Middle East (e.g. Egypt, Sudan, Palestine, Iraq), East and West Africa (e.g. Kenya, Uganda, Tanganyika, Gold Coast, Nigeria), Southern Africa (South Africa should be studied only as far as self-government in 1910, apart from as an agent of change in other parts of the region, plus, for example, North and South Rhodesia, Nyasaland, Bechuanaland), the Caribbean,

Canada and Australia/New Zealand. The focus is on the British Empire, and knowledge is not expected of other European empires, but learners may draw in knowledge of developments in other empires in so far as they impacted the British Empire. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation of each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: From Colonialism to Independence: The British Empire 1857–1965	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The governance and administration of the Empire	The Empire in 1857; explanations for the growth of the British Empire: formal and informal Empire (including New Imperialism c.1875–1914 and the imperialism of free trade); Berlin Conference (1884–1885); economic explanations (overseas investment, crisis of capitalism, gentlemanly capitalism), imperial rivalry, metropolitan influence; forms of governance; security and coercion; trusteeship; ‘men on the spot’; collaboration and indigenous elites; the use of technology; negotiation.
Opposition to British Rule	Opposition movements, peaceful and violent; reasons for their development, nature and impact including South Africa, India, Sudan, Malaya, Kenya; the rise of Nationalism including India and Gandhi, Kenya and Kenyatta, Nkrumah in Ghana and Pan-Africanism; reasons for, methods, success, consequences for Britain and its colonies.
The impact of imperial power on the periphery and Britain	Orientalism, patterns of work, famine, technological progress, disease and medicine, national identities, religion, gender, education, the erosion and preservation of indigenous culture, sport, law and order; jingoism, indifference, exhibitions, school texts and national identity, youth organisations, the arts (fine art, drama, Music Halls cinema), metropolitan politics, international relations, the economy.
The British Empire and its impact on international relations	Empire and European rivalry in the 19 th and early 20 th centuries; ‘Splendid Isolation’ and retreat from it; colonial wars and their impact, Empire and the World Wars; Empire and Britain’s relationship with the League of Nations and UN; Empire and Britain’s relationship with the USA; Empire in the age of the Cold War, the Commonwealth; relations with Europe and EEC.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
British India: The War of 1857 and its consequences to 1876	British India in 1857; the course of the rebellion and reasons for its failure; the consequences of the Uprising in India and internationally including impact on British attitudes and methods of rule.
Palestine 1914–1948	Status and causes of Zionist-Palestinian problem by 1914; the First World War and the Balfour Declaration; the British Mandate and issues in the interwar period including uprisings and immigration and their consequences; reasons for and immediate consequences of partition in 1948.
Nationalism in Kenya 1945–1965	Reasons for rise of Nationalism; Mau Mau rebellion: causes, nature of, impact; problem of settlers and the Indian population; importance of Kenyatta; changing British policy towards Kenya especially Macmillan; reasons for and nature of final independence settlement, impact of, and on, international context e.g. Cold War, Commonwealth.